INDIAN RAILWAYS

Network & Traffic Analytics

Passenger demand, freight movement and infrastructure

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6,905 million
passenger journeys
in FY 2023-24

69,181 km
route length
in FY 2023-24

5.4x
journey count
vs 1950-51

Executive summary

- Passenger journeys rose from 1,284 million in 1950-51 to 6,905 million in 2023-24; passenger-kilometres grew 16.0x.
- Route length increased 29.1% across selected observations; revenue-earning freight tonnes increased 21.7x.
- Uttar Pradesh had the largest state route length (8,823 km); Northern had the largest zone route length (7,406 km).
- There were 40 consequential accidents in 2023-24; derailments were 62.5% of that total.

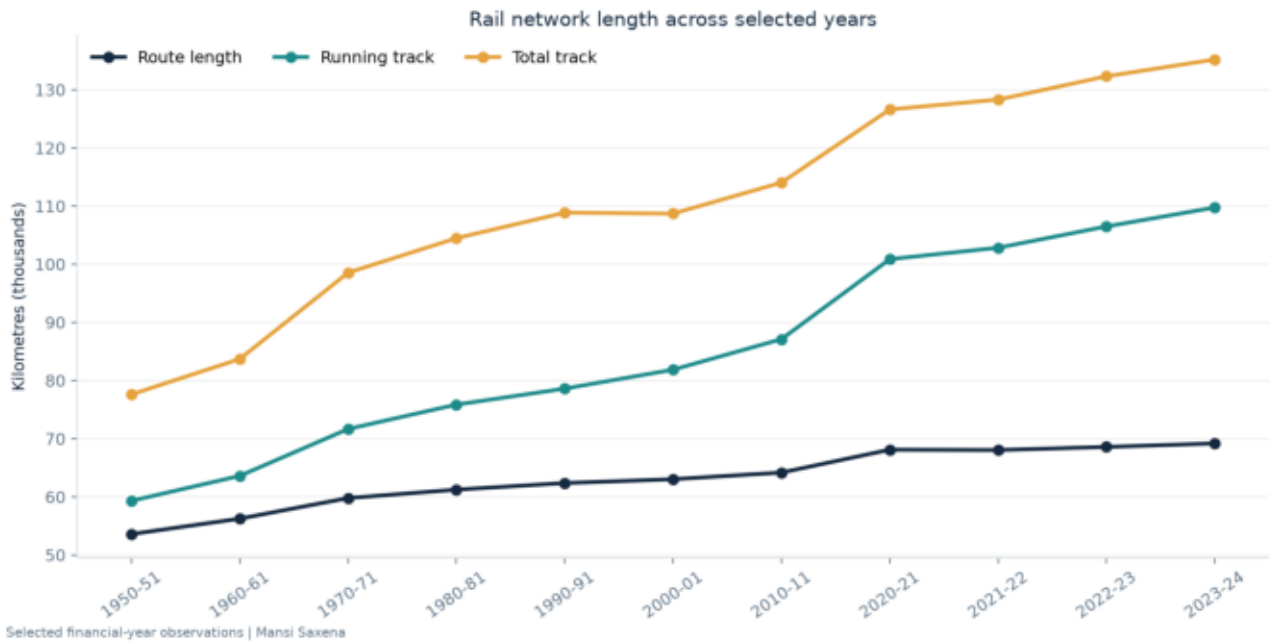
Selected financial-year snapshots are not a complete annual panel. These descriptive statistics do not establish causes or predict future performance.

Passenger use and network length

Passenger demand index (1950-51 = 100)

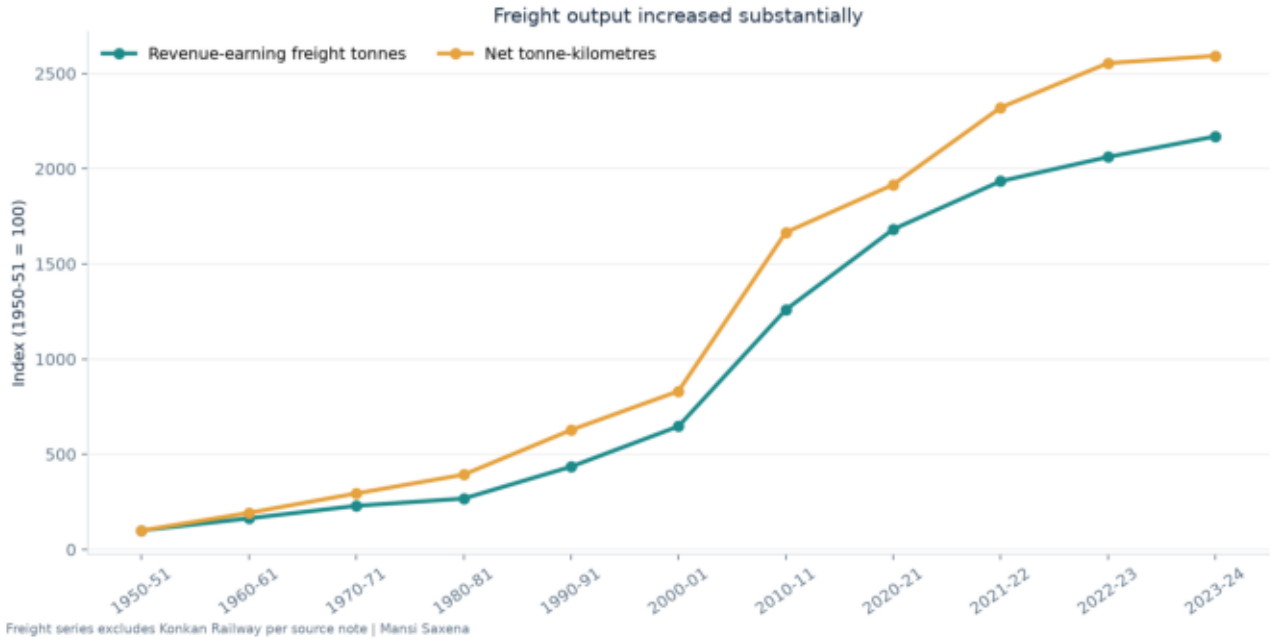


Network length

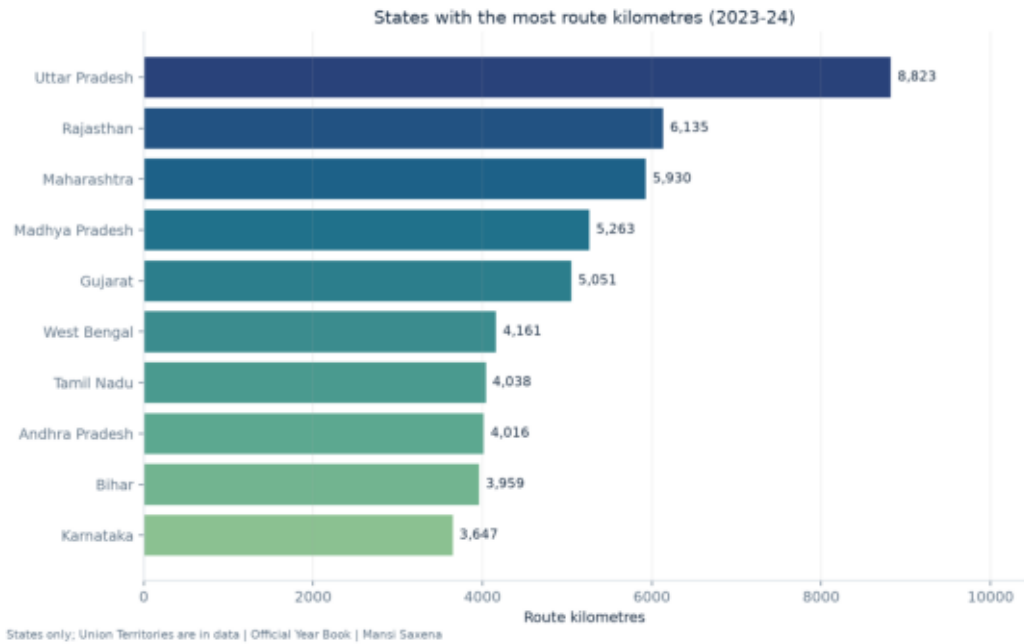


Freight movement and state infrastructure

Freight output index

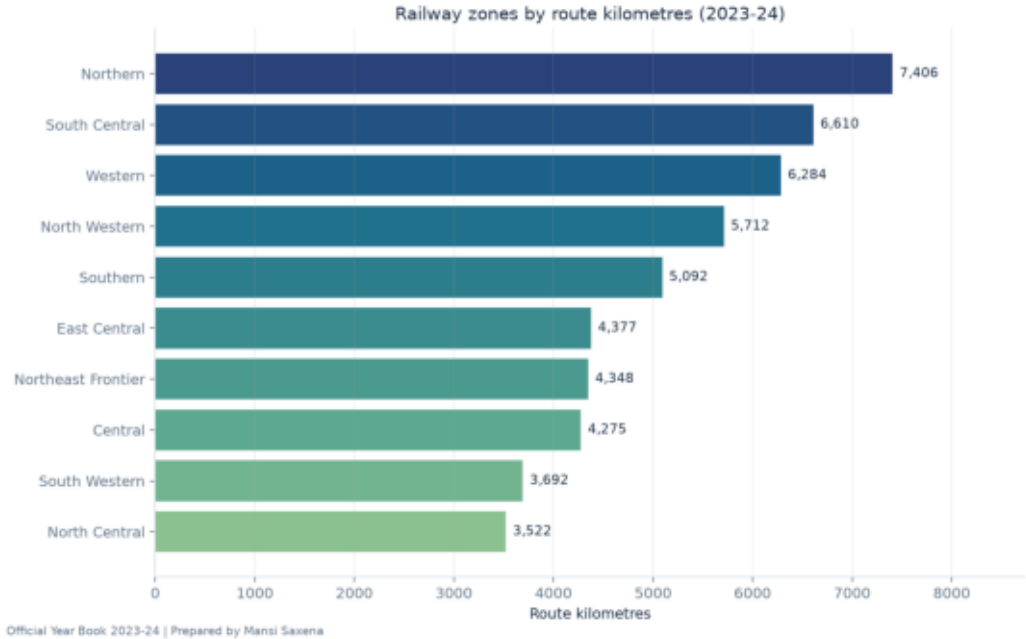


Top states by route kilometres

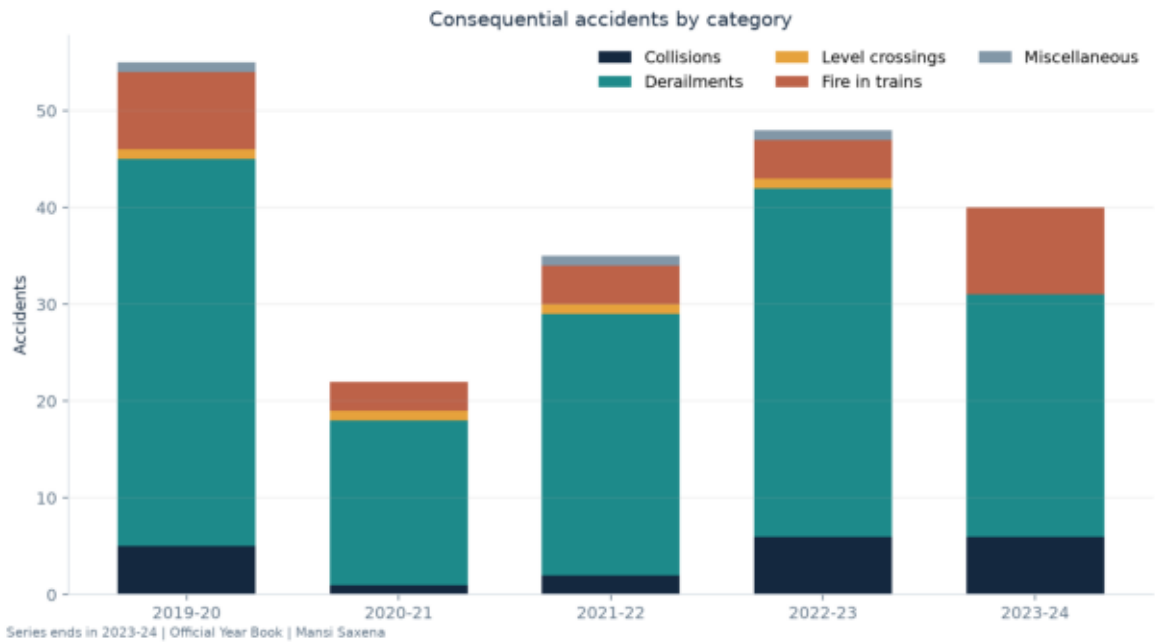


Railway zones and safety context

Zone route kilometres



Accident categories, 2019-20 to 2023-24



Method, definitions and limitations

Primary source	Ministry of Railways (Railway Board), Indian Railways Year Book 2023-24, pp. 23-24, 40, 53, 61-63.
Measures	Passenger originating counts journeys in millions; passenger-kilometres are in millions; freight tonnes and net tonne-kilometres are millions. Route, running-track and total-track kilometres are distinct measures.
Coverage	Historical figures are only the observations printed in the Year Book. State and zone figures are a 2023-24 snapshot. The freight series excludes Konkan Railway as noted in the source.
Safety caveat	Consequential-accident counts use the report's category definition and are not a complete safety assessment.
Source data quality	Goa is listed with 122 running-track km and 113 total-track km. Both published figures are preserved; this apparent inconsistency is flagged, not silently corrected.
Interpretation	COVID-19 affected passenger services in 2020-21. Sparse observations and changing operating conditions limit comparisons; no causal claim or forecast is made.
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